



The Morning Brief

MAY 25, 2026

Taking Shape

Memorial Day Edition — A 14-point US-Iran memorandum of understanding is under negotiation as the S&P holds near all-time highs and CRDO surges 13% on AI connectivity momentum.

S&P 500 (FRI CLOSE)	BRENT (FRI CLOSE)	GOLD (FRI CLOSE)	CRDO (FRI CLOSE)	FEAR & GREED
~7,473 ↑0.40%	~\$103 ↓1.0%	~\$4,510 ↓0.8%	\$218.43 ↑12.95%	30 · Fear

SECTION 01

Markets — Memorial Day Edition

BROADEST RALLY IN WEEKS AS PEACE DEAL TAKES SHAPE

Friday closed with the broadest participation since the war began. Ten of eleven sectors finished positive, with healthcare (+1.19%), tech (+1.01%), and utilities (+0.80%) leading. Only communications services (−0.53%) declined. SPY closed at \$745.66 (+0.40%), the Dow gained 0.60%, the Nasdaq added 0.43%, and the Russell 2000 led at +0.94%. The broad participation is the notable signal: prior sessions at these levels were tech-concentrated with narrow breadth. Friday’s tape suggests the rally is widening as institutional positioning normalizes and peace deal expectations spread across sectors. Fear & Greed sits at 30, still in Fear territory despite the broad green tape—suggesting further positioning room if the diplomatic track produces a framework this week.

S&P 500	~7,457 · Near ATH · 10 of 11 sectors green
CRDO	\$218.43 · ↑12.95% · Analyst upgrades + DustPhotonics
QCOM	\$238.18 · ↑11.61% · China chip thaw beneficiary
OIL	Brent ↓1.0% · Declining on peace progress
FEAR & GREED	30 · Fear · Room for positioning normalization

CRDO +12.95% AND QCOM +11.61% — THE Q2 ADDITIONS CONTINUE TO DELIVER

Credo Technology surged 12.95% to \$218.43 on Friday after Zacks upgraded the stock to Strong Buy and Rothschild &

Co Redburn initiated coverage with a Buy rating and \$206 target. The company’s DustPhotonics acquisition, announced in April and expected to close this quarter, enhances vertical integration in silicon photonics. CRDO reports Q4 results June 1. QCOM gained 11.61% to \$238.18 as China chip export thaw expectations continued to build following the Trump-Xi summit. NXPI added 5.72%, VST rose 4.84%, and AMD gained 3.99%. The semiconductor and AI infrastructure sleeves remain the portfolio’s highest-conviction positions. **The physical world matters.**

The broadest rally in weeks at all-time-high levels, a peace deal taking shape, and the two newest IOWN holdings (CRDO, VST) among the week's top performers. The portfolio was constructed for the physical AI infrastructure cycle. The market is validating that thesis in real time. Think Like an Owner.

Geopolitics

14-POINT MOU UNDER NEGOTIATION — THE CLOSEST TO A DEAL SINCE FEBRUARY 28

The US and Iran are negotiating a 14-point memorandum of understanding to end the war, according to Axios and CNN. Secretary of State Rubio described the deal as “still a work in progress,” while Iran’s Foreign Ministry stated that “conclusions have been reached on many topics” but an agreement is not imminent, per Reuters. The framework would include Iran’s commitment to address its highly enriched uranium stockpile (though Iranian and US sources offer conflicting accounts of what has been agreed), reopen the Strait of Hormuz with demining, and establish a 60-day window for final deal points. Nuclear negotiations have been deferred to a later phase. Iranian state media reported that differences persist over one or two clauses. Trump stated negotiations are “proceeding nicely.” Xi praised Pakistan’s mediation efforts and Iran’s engagement, while Netanyahu admitted difficulty influencing Trump’s decisions on Iran, per Reuters. For markets, the MOU represents the most concrete path to resolution since the conflict began—oil continues to decline on peace expectations, with Brent falling 0.97% on Friday.

THE SUPPLY CHAIN IS ALREADY ADAPTING — INDIA PIVOTS TO LATIN AMERICA AND AFRICA

India has turned to Latin American and African oil sources after the Hormuz disruption, per Reuters, while Russian crude volumes to India hit record levels during the conflict. The global energy supply chain has been permanently rerouted by three months of Hormuz disruption, and even a peace deal would not immediately reverse the structural changes. For IOWN’s energy sleeve, this means CVX, VLO, OKE, and CTRA benefit from both the near-term disruption

premium and the longer-term supply chain reconfiguration that the war has catalyzed.

MOU14 points · Rubio: “work in progress” · Days from finalization	
FRAMEWORKHEU handover · Hormuz demining · 60-day final deal window	
NUCLEAR	Deferred to later phase · Not in initial MOU
NETANYAHU	Admits difficulty influencing Trump on Iran
INDIA	Pivoting to Latin American, African oil

On Our Radar

1. Week Ahead: CRDO reports June 1, and the MOU could finalize this week. Rubio indicated the memorandum could be completed within days. If it is, oil could retrace toward the pre-war level near \$70 Brent, and the equity rally would likely broaden further. CRDO's Q4/FY2026 results on June 1 are the next major test for the Q2 additions. The DustPhotonics acquisition and AI connectivity demand trajectory will be the focus. *Research Reveals Opportunities.*

2. Fear & Greed at 30 despite all-time highs creates an asymmetric setup. The index has drifted from 50 (neutral) back to 30 (Fear) even as equities held near records. If the MOU materializes and oil declines further, the sentiment gauge could catch up to the price action rapidly. The gap between price and positioning is the opportunity. *Avoid Erosion.*

3. The semiconductor sleeve now includes four names that have posted double-digit single-session gains since the Q2 rebalance. CRDO +12.95% Friday, AMD +13.91% (May 8), QCOM +11.61% Friday, and MRVL +8.18% (May 13). The AI infrastructure thesis is delivering at the holding level, not just the index level. **Simplicity Over Complexity.**

4. CTRA remains under pressure at -8.62%. The Devon Energy merger dynamics continue to weigh. The holding warrants monitoring through the merger close, though the underlying cash generation (\$1.646B Q1 operating cash flow) remains strong. The energy sleeve's thesis transitions as the peace deal approaches: from war premium to structural supply repositioning. *Think Like an Owner.*

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